

# Thomas J. Hughes

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## Education

### **George Mason University**

Fairfax, Virginia

Economics PhD Candidate, ABD

Expected Graduation: May 2027

MA Economics

Awarded May 16, 2025

Fields: Austrian Economics; Economic Sociology and Political Economy

### **Mercer University**

Macon, Georgia

Bachelor of Arts, **Major:** Mathematics and Economics

Graduation: May 2023

**Minor:** Statistics

**Certificate:** Actuarial Science

## Fellowships and Affiliations

### **PhD Fellowship, Mercatus Center**

August 2023-present

**Graduate Fellow, F.A. Hayek Program for Advanced Study in Philosophy, Politics, and Economics,**

**Mercatus Center**

August 2023-present

**Network Member, Initiative for the Study of a Stable Peace**

January 2024-present

## Professional Work

### **Graduate Lecturer (George Mason University)**

August 2026-present

Course taught: Intermediate Microeconomics (ECON 306)

### **Graduate Teaching Assistant—Instructor of Record (George Mason University)**

August 2025-May 2026

Courses taught: Four sections of Contemporary Macroeconomic Principles (ECON 104)

Course Evaluations:

Fall 2025: [Section 004](#); [Section 008](#)

Spring 2026: [Section 001](#); [Section 010](#)

### **Graduate Research Assistant (George Mason University)**

August 2023-July 2025; August 2026-present

Assistant for Christopher J. Coyne during the 2023-2024, 2024-2025, and 2026-2027 academic year and the summer 2025 term.

Assistant for Peter J. Boettke during the summer 2024 term.

### **Preceptor (Mercer University)**

August 2020-May 2021

Led four total sections of calculus 1 preceptor classes for the Department of Mathematics.

## Published Papers

Bureaucratic Control After *Loper Bright Enterprises v. Raimondo*: The Rise of Judicial Control in a Post-Chevron Deference World (forthcoming at the Journal of Public Finance and Public Choice)

### **Under Review**

The Weapon Itself is the Threat: Nuclear Weapons, the Knowledge Problem, and Normal Accidents (under review at Cosmos + Taxis; co-authored with Christopher J. Coyne, George Mason University)

The Budget-Maximizing Peacemaker: The Success Paradox of Peace-Through-Strength Defense Policy (under review at Public Choice).

### **Working Papers**

Does Government-Nonprofit Contracting Instantiate Democratic Priority-Setting? (co-authored with Brian Mandeville, George Mason University).

### **Works In Progress**

#### **Papers**

Centripetal and Centrifugal Forces in Single-Dimensional Computational Spatial Voting Models (co-authored with Robi Ragan, Mercer University)

Doctoral Failure: A Subjectivist Model of Exploitative Medical Behavior under Moral Constraints

When Truth Can Be Bad for Business: A Theory of Expert Failure in Religious Leadership (co-authored with Roger Koppl, Syracuse University)

William Niskanen and the Economics of Bureaucracy: Theory, Influence, and Policy Legacy

#### **Books/Monographs**

The Machinery of Administration: Bureaucracy in Mainline Economics (co-authored with Christopher J. Coyne; in progress)

### **Honors and Awards**

**Young Scholar, Association for Private Enterprise Education** April 2026

**Student Fellow of the Public Choice Society** March 2026

**Outstanding Award in Research, Stetson-Hatcher School of Business at Mercer University** April 2023

Article: Centripetal and Centrifugal Forces in Single-Dimensional Computational Spatial Voting Models

**Center for the Study of Economics and Liberty Research Grant, Mercer University** January 2023

Article: Centripetal and Centrifugal Forces in Single-Dimensional Computational Spatial Voting Models

### **Professional Service**

#### **Referee**

*Journal of Public Finance and Public Choice*

### **Conferences**

**Association of Private Enterprise Education Meeting**

April 5-7, 2026

Las Vegas, Nevada

Presented: The Budget-Maximizing Peacemaker: The Success Paradox of Peace-Through-Strength Defense Policy & The Weapon Itself is the Threat: Nuclear Weapons, the Knowledge Problem, and Civilizational Risk

**Public Choice Society**

March 12-14, 2026

San Antonio, Texas

Presented: The Budget-Maximizing Peacemaker: The Success Paradox of Peace-Through-Strength Defense Policy

**Southern Economic Association**

November 22-24, 2025

Tampa, Florida

Presented: Bureaucratic Control After *Loper Bright Enterprises v. Raimondo*: The Rise of Judicial Control in a Post-Chevron Deference World & Doctoral Failure: A Subjectivist Model of Exploitative Medical Behavior under Moral Constraint

**Markets and Society Conference**

October 17-20, 2025

Falls Church, Virginia

Presented: The Weapon Itself is the Threat: Nuclear Weapons, the Knowledge Problem, and Civilizational Risk

**Society of Business, Industry, and Economics**

April 12-14, 2023

Destin, Florida

Presented: Centripetal and Centrifugal Forces in Single-Dimensional Computational Spatial Voting Models

**References**

**Chris Coyne**

Department of Economics

George Mason University

[ccoyne3@gmu.edu](mailto:ccoyne3@gmu.edu)

**Rosolino Candela**

Mercatus Center at George Mason University

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**Peter Boettke**

Distinguished University Professor of Economics and Philosophy

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**Robi Ragan**

Department of Economic

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